Short-arc shoulder raise

Shoulder control / 6-10 easy repetitions



START / arms lowered FINISH / short comfortable arc

MAIN: Middle deltoid contributes to lifting the arm out to the side.

SECONDARY: Supraspinatus assists the lift; rotator-cuff and scapular muscles coordinate the shoulder.

BASE / SUPPORT: Trunk muscles and planted feet keep the torso quiet; a chair supports the seated base.

01 / Check the setup

Begin without a band. Use a stable chair with room at both sides. This is a comfortable movement rehearsal, not a heavy raise.

02 / Set the base and brace

Sit tall, feet planted, elbows softly bent and hands relaxed. Start with arms beside the body.

03 / Move with control

Lift in a slightly forward plane with thumbs comfortably forward or up. Breathe normally and keep the neck relaxed.

04 / Limit the range and return

Use a small pain-free arc below shoulder height; stop sooner if the shoulder hikes, pinches or the torso leans.

WATCH FOR: Do not force the arms overhead or use a shrug to gain height. A smaller controlled arc is the aim. EASIER: Move one arm at a time through a shorter comfortable arc, or omit if symptoms occur.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: AAOS - Shoulder Conditioning Program; ACE - Resistance-band workout builder. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html